SURFING

Surfing Australia · the Irukandjis · supported through the QAS surfing program

TRAINING BASE
Hyundai Surfing Australia High Performance Centre at Casuarina on the Tweed Coast in NSW, about 15 minutes south of the Gold Coast.

LEADERSHIP
Chris Symington (CEO), Kate Wilcomes (National HP Director), Paula Charlton (Performance Support Manager), Dion Atkinson (Head of Podium) and Luke Macdonald (Head of Pathway).

QAS IN THE PROGRAM
QAS staff listed by the sport: Glen Workman (lead physical preparation), Tom Greer-Smith (pathway psychology), Dr John Ward (chief medical officer) and Kerry O'Bryan (dietetics).

SCALE
45 nationally categorised athletes in 2026 across the AIS categories from Emerging to Podium. Each athlete holds an individual performance plan.

CURRENT STATUS

- Molly Picklum is the reigning WSL world champion (2025). Her win at the Rip Curl Pro Portugal on 23 October 2026 returned her to world number one with the Philippines and Pipeline events still to run.
- The Irukandjis won the 2025 ISA World Surfing Games in El Salvador. It was Australia's first open team gold since 2011.
- The 2026 ISA World Surfing Games run at Punta Rocas in Peru from 6 to 15 November. The team is Stephanie Gilmore, Tyler Wright and Leihani Zoric with Jack Robinson, Ethan Ewing and George Pittar.

LA28 INCLUSION AND HOPES

- Confirmed for LA28 at Lower Trestles in California with 48 surfers (24 per gender) and a maximum of two per nation per gender.
- The top men's and women's teams at the 2026 and 2027 World Surfing Games each earn one extra place for their nation. Most places come through the 2028 Championship Tour and the 2028 World Surfing Games.
- Paris 2024 delivered silver to Jack Robinson after Owen Wright's bronze in Tokyo. An Olympic gold is the stated ambition.

GOALS AND EXPECTATIONS

- Vision: to support Australian athletes to become the world's best surfers and people and to be known as the dominant surfing nation.
- Pillars: athlete centred, coach supported, performance focused and an integrated performance team. Values: Limitless, Authentic, Elite and Fun.
- CEO Chris Symington called the June 2026 federal high performance funding a powerful vote of confidence tied to the Win Well strategy and the goal of winning gold at LA28 and Brisbane 2032.

RECENT RESULTS

WHEN	RESULT
Oct 2026	Molly Picklum wins Rip Curl Pro Portugal and retakes the WSL lead
Sep 2026	GOLD ISA World Junior team title in El Salvador. Third in a row and tenth overall
Sep 2026	Junior world titles to Leihani Zoric (U18 at age 13), Locana Cullen and Lucy Darragh (U16)
Jan 2026	Isla Huppatz and Dane Henry crowned 2025 WSL world junior champions
Sep 2025	GOLD ISA World Surfing Games team title. Picklum wins the WSL world title
Aug 2024	SILVER Jack Robinson at the Paris Olympics (Teahupo'o)

ACHIEVEMENTS

- A senior world champion and a world junior team three-peat give the program depth at both ends.
- The integrated team blends Surfing Australia and QAS practitioners around a shared individual plan.

STRUGGLES AND WATCH POINTS

- No Olympic gold yet and no Australian women's Olympic medal.
- The tour calendar keeps podium athletes away from the centre for long periods. Paula Charlton described surfing at interview as having a rhythm to the lack of rhythm.
- No documented culture concerns were found in public sources.

WORTH EXPLORING ON THE VISIT

How QAS support follows podium athletes on tour and what stays at Casuarina.

How junior world champions are carried into Challenger and Championship Tour careers.

What the Peru result changes for team places and LA28 planning.

Sources. surfingaustralia.com (High Performance; Irukandjis news 15 Sep 2026; 19 Jan 2026; 18 Jun 2026) · ABC News 24 Oct 2026 · Sportzhub 23 Oct 2026 · Rio Times (2026 ISA WSG) · QAS interview debrief 15 Oct 2026.

SKATEBOARDING

Skate Australia · park and street · supported through the QAS skateboarding program

TRAINING BASE
No single daily training environment. Athletes train at home parks and travel to world events. QAS backed an indoor street training facility on the Gold Coast in 2024.

LEADERSHIP
Alex Anasson (CEO), Daniel Mangano (General Manager Skateboarding High Performance) and Shari Duffy (National Technical Lead) in a dual leadership model.

SUPPORT TEAM
Kenny Dudek (Operations Manager, formerly AusCycling) and Dr Tom McWilliams (Chief Medical Officer). The structure was built through 2025.

GOLD COAST LINKS
Arisa Trew grew up at Palm Beach. Keegan Palmer grew up on the Gold Coast and moved to San Diego at 14. The Gold Coast hosted the 2026 national park and street championships.

CURRENT STATUS

- Australia launched its LA28 campaign at the WST Rome World Cup in June 2026 with ten park and nine street skaters.
- 2026 has been a building year at the top level. Arisa Trew was fourth and Keefer Wilson fifth at the São Paulo World Championships in March.
- At the World Skate Games in Paraguay in October Chloe Covell won street silver. No Australian reached either park podium.

LA28 INCLUSION AND HOPES

- Park and street are confirmed for LA28.
- Qualification runs from June 2026 to June 2028 through the World Skateboarding Ranking. It is an 18 month rolling system where only an athlete's best results count and World Championships carry greater value.
- Trew and Palmer are the reigning Olympic park champions. Covell leads the street hopes.

GOALS AND EXPECTATIONS

- The 2025 appointments were framed as the start of a world-class system from participation through to elite level on the road to LA28 and Brisbane 2032.
- Shari Duffy's priorities are coach development, an inclusive culture and protecting the essence of Australian skateboarding.
- CEO Alex Anasson described the 2026 national championships as part of the green and gold runway toward Brisbane 2032.

RECENT RESULTS

WHEN	RESULT
Oct 2026	SILVER Chloe Covell, women's street, World Skate Games Paraguay
Oct 2026	BRONZE Hudson Walker, men's vert (not an Olympic event)
2026	BRONZE Keegan Palmer, park, X Games Chiba
Jun 2026	WST Rome World Cup: Palmer fifth and Trew sixth in park
Mar 2026	São Paulo World Championships: Trew fourth, Keefer Wilson fifth, Palmer eighth
2025	GOLD Arisa Trew, park and vert, X Games Osaka

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Paris 2024:** park gold to Arisa Trew at 14 as Australia's youngest Olympic champion. Keegan Palmer won a second straight Olympic title.
- A deep young park group with Olympic and X Games winners still in their teens and early twenties.

STRUGGLES AND WATCH POINTS

- Since Paris the major park medals have gone elsewhere and rivals have lifted their scoring.
- Skate Australia acknowledged challenges faced by the team during the World Skate Games without detailing them.
- A young and widely dispersed group raises duty of care, travel and wellbeing demands. The high performance structure is still new.

WORTH EXPLORING ON THE VISIT

How QAS support reaches skaters who train at home parks or overseas.

Duty of care for minors on tour and the wellbeing support around them.

What a daily training environment for park and street could look like before 2032.

Sources. skateaustralia.org.au (leadership 29 Sep 2025; Rome 15 Jun 2026; São Paulo 11 Mar 2026; World Skate Games news) · NSWIS 10 Jun 2026 · World Skate 14 Oct 2026 · Wyldata park results · Australasian Leisure Management 7 Jul 2026 · Wikipedia (Trew, Palmer).

PADDLE

Paddle Australia · canoe sprint and paracanoe on the Gold Coast · slalom based at Penrith

TRAINING BASE
National Training Centre on the Gold Coast for sprint kayak. The European season runs from the AIS European Training Centre in Italy. Slalom trains at Penrith in NSW.

LEADERSHIP
Kim Crane (CEO), Brendan Purcell (High Performance Director) and Jimmy Owens (Head Coach) who leads the merged men's and women's sprint groups.

PROGRAM DESIGN
The sprint National Centre of Excellence was restructured after Paris to build medal-winning men's and women's K2 and K4 crews for LA28 and sustain them to 2032.

STRATEGY
Paddle Forward '32. Purcell credits the merged sprint and paracanoe structure with building a strong team culture.

CURRENT STATUS

- A strong 2026. The sprint and paracanoe team won 17 World Cup medals including six gold across Hungary, Germany and Canada.
- At the World Championships in Poznan (26 to 30 August) Australia finished third on the medal table with four gold, one silver and two bronze.
- The slalom team won three gold and one silver at the World Championships in Oklahoma City, the LA28 slalom venue.

LA28 INCLUSION AND HOPES

- Canoe sprint and canoe slalom are on the LA28 program and paracanoe is on the Paralympic program.
- Sprint qualification is ranking based from April 2026 to December 2027. World Championships carry one and a half times the points of a World Cup.
- Hopes centre on Tom Green, the van der Westhuyzen brothers, Natalia Drobot and Kailey Harlen in sprint, Jessica Fox in slalom and Curtis McGrath in paracanoe.

BRISBANE 2032

- In September 2026 the Fitzroy River at Rockhampton was cleared to host rowing and canoe sprint. Paddle Worldwide endorsed the independent report.
- Canoe slalom is planned for the Redland Whitewater Centre at Birkdale.

RECENT RESULTS

WHEN	RESULT
Aug 2026	GOLD Tom Green, K1 500m, his first world title, plus K1 1000m bronze
Aug 2026	GOLD Natalia Drobot and Kailey Harlen, K2. First Australian women's K2 world champions since 1998
Aug 2026	GOLD Curtis McGrath, KL2 200m, his 13th world title
Jul 2026	GOLD Jessica Fox, kayak cross time trial, less than a year after kidney tumour surgery
Jul 2026	17 World Cup medals (6 gold) with Ben Sainsbury winning two VL1 golds
Aug 2024	SILVER Men's K4 500m at the Paris Olympics

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Olympic champions in the squad including Green and Jean van der Westhuyzen (K2 1000m, Tokyo) and Jessica Fox in slalom.
- Drobot was the 2025 Paddler of the Year at 21 and has turned World silver into gold.

STRUGGLES AND WATCH POINTS

- New personnel and structures came in at the start of the cycle and are still bedding in.
- The team spends the northern summer in Europe so QAS presence is seasonal.
- Slalom sits outside the Gold Coast base. The Rockhampton venue drew public debate over crocodile safety before it was cleared.

WORTH EXPLORING ON THE VISIT

How QAS support travels with the team through the European block.

How sprint and paracanoe share staff and what the merger has changed.

What a Rockhampton venue means for home preparation toward 2032.

Sources. paddle.org.au (31 Aug 2026; 5 Aug 2026; 31 Jul 2026; 15 Jul 2026; 7 May 2026) · NSWIS 14 Aug 2025 and Paris K4 report · Sportspeople (Senior National Coach Sprint Kayak, Jun 2025) · Newcastle Herald 21 Jul 2026 · Reuters via The Star 17 Sep 2026 · Topend Sports (2032 venues).

TRIATHLON

AusTriathlon · Olympic and para triathlon · national home on the Gold Coast

TRAINING BASE
AusTriathlon High Performance Hub at the Miami Aquatic Centre on the Gold Coast, opened 11 August 2026 with the City of Gold Coast. Home of the Ascent Academy.

LEADERSHIP
Tim Harradine (CEO) and Shaun Stephens (High Performance Director). Senior team: Maxine Seear, Tim Kerrison, Dr Annette Eastwood and Megan Hall (Paralympic program).

SCALE
More than 90 national pathway athletes are expected to use the hub regularly. The Gold Coast is the proposed Brisbane 2032 triathlon venue.

STRATEGY
A refreshed high performance program and 2032+ strategy launched in May 2025 under the Win Well banner.

CURRENT STATUS

- Matt Hauser won four WTCS races in 2026 including the Grand Final in Pontevedra. He finished second in the series to Vasco Vilaça of Portugal.
- Hauser won the 2025 series title, Australia's first World Triathlon Championship Series crown in 20 years.
- Lauren Parker won her sixth world para triathlon title in 2026 and is now Australia's most successful para triathlete.

LA28 INCLUSION AND HOPES

- Individual triathlon and the mixed relay are on the LA28 program and para triathlon is on the Paralympic program.
- The Olympic qualification period runs from May 2026 to May 2028.
- Hauser and Luke Willian lead the men. Parker, Anu Francis and the vision impaired pairs lead the para team.

GOALS AND EXPECTATIONS

- The 2025 relaunch set out to achieve podium success on the world stage and rebuild belief in Australian triathlon's high performance results.
- The horizon is LA28, the 2030 Commonwealth Games and Brisbane 2032. Stephens wants athletes ready to win well.
- Harradine sees the hub supporting current athletes and the next generation through to 2032.

RECENT RESULTS

WHEN	RESULT
Sep 2026	GOLD Matt Hauser, Grand Final in Pontevedra, by 0.08 seconds
Sep 2026	GOLD Lauren Parker, PTWC world title. Anu Francis silver in PTS2
Jul 2026	GOLD Hauser wins WTCS Hamburg and WTCS London
May 2026	GOLD Hauser wins WTCS Yokohama with Luke Willian third. Six para medals on the same weekend
Mar 2026	Oceania Championships: Australian clean sweeps in both elite races
Oct 2025	GOLD Hauser wins the 2025 World Championship Series title

ACHIEVEMENTS

- A world class men's leader and a para program with world champions across several classes.
- A purpose-built Gold Coast hub that links pathway and podium in one place.

STRUGGLES AND WATCH POINTS

- No Australian Olympic triathlon medal since London 2012.
- No Australian woman reached a WTCS podium in 2026 and Australia was off the podium at both mixed relay events.
- Privately backed middle distance racing such as the T100 has drawn some athletes away from the Olympic distance.

WORTH EXPLORING ON THE VISIT

The plan to build women's depth and a medal-capable mixed relay by 2028.

How QAS practitioners connect with the new hub and the Ascent Academy.

How the para program and the Olympic program share support and coaching.

Sources. triathlon.org.au (hub 11 Aug 2026; Yokohama 16 May 2026; relaunch 9 May 2025; leadership 5 Feb 2025) · ABC News 28 Sep 2026 and 19 Oct 2025 · Wikipedia 2026 WTCS · AAP (Snowsill, late 2024) · Australasian Leisure Management.

QUEENSLAND ACADEMY OF SPORT

Vision for 2032: to inspire extraordinary sporting success · Minister: Tim Mander, Sport and Racing and the Olympic and Paralympic Games

STATUS
Independent statutory body since 1 July 2025 under the Queensland Academy of Sport Act 2025. The government says this was 12 months ahead of the previous plan.

BOARD
David Lyons (Chair) · Alex Baumann · Cate Campbell · Ben Ikin · Mark James · Annette Maidment · Susan Rix · Ella Sabljak

EXECUTIVE
Troy Ayres (CEO), Dave Crosbee (High Performance Programs), Mark Young (Performance Support), David Noble (Coaching and Talent) and Annabel Kehoe (Corporate Services).

SCALE
132 staff (122.3 FTE). Funding of $40.5m in 2025 to 2026, with $37.7m from the Queensland Government. The 2026 to 2027 budget is $43.8m.

LA28 TARGETS

QUEENSLAND'S CONTRIBUTION

28+	28+	12+ / 8+
Olympic medals and 44+ Olympic medallists	Paralympic medals and 27+ Paralympic medallists	Olympic and Paralympic sports winning medals

2032 HIGH PERFORMANCE STRATEGY

PILLARS	Athlete journey · Coaching and talent · Performance support · Performance programs · Performance enablers
OBJECTIVES	Target 2028 (medals in more sports at LA28) · Athlete Progression · Performance Systems · Brand and Growth
VALUES	Start with the athlete · Our people. Our superpower. · Freedom to fly. Embrace the responsibility. · Be curious. Be courageous. · United by excellence.

2025 TO 2026 IN NUMBERS

- 74 medals at major international events by QAS-supported athletes.
- 60 QAS-supported athletes among 87 Queenslanders selected for Glasgow 2026.
- The Para Unit welcomed 24 new athletes and has identified 64 across 18 sports since 2025.
- YouFor2032 took 123 athletes into its development phase with 14 progressing to high performance programs.
- A new Catapult partnership and a research and innovation summit with more than 150 attendees.

RISKS QAS NAMES ITSELF

- Fewer athletes entering the high performance system.
- Barriers in the Paralympic pathway.
- Hosting 2032 distracting from sustained success after the Games.
- An internal audit function is being established in 2026 to 2027.

RECENT MEDIA

NEWEST FIRST

WHEN	RESULT
Oct 2026	Annual Report 2025 to 2026 released, the first full year as a statutory body
8 Oct 2026	Townsville Regional Hub pilot launched for up to 30 athletes over 12 months, reducing travel to Brisbane
17 Sep 2026	Rockhampton's Fitzroy River cleared for 2032 rowing and canoe sprint
11 Aug 2026	AusTriathlon opens its Gold Coast hub at Miami
1 Jul 2026	One year as a statutory body with 61 QAS athletes named for Glasgow 2026

KEY STATEMENTS

Our responsibility is not only to help athletes perform in 2032 but to strengthen the high performance system.
TROY AYRES, CEO · ANNUAL REPORT 2025 TO 2026

The work we do today will shape Queensland's success for years to come.
TROY AYRES · 1 JULY 2026

The next phase is about converting that foundation into lasting outcomes.
DAVID LYONS, CHAIR · ANNUAL REPORT 2025 TO 2026

The first year has been about building capability and capacity.
DAVID LYONS · 1 JULY 2026

CONNECTION POINTS WITH THE EXECUTIVES

SUGGESTED LINKS TO YOUR OWN WORK

WHO	THEIR FOCUS	A NATURAL CONNECTION
Troy Ayres	Strengthening the system beyond 2032	System design and staff development across six Red Sox sites rather than direct delivery.
Dave Crosbee	High performance programs and Target 2028. Formerly with Great Britain Canoe Slalom	Investment that follows each sport's What It Takes To Win. Paddle gives an easy shared starting point.
Mark Young	Performance support and embedded practitioners	Supporting the four Performance Support Managers as a peer group.
David Noble	Coaching, talent and YouFor2032	Moving junior world champions in surfing and pathway triathletes into senior programs.
Alex Baumann	Chairs the board's Performance and Pathways Committee. Former HPSNZ and Swimming Australia chief executive	Your early career with High Performance Sport New Zealand.

Sources. QAS Annual Report 2025 to 2026 (qasport.com.au) · QAS news 8 Oct 2026 · Queensland Ministerial Media Statements 1 Jul 2026 and 8 Oct 2026 · Reuters via The Star 17 Sep 2026 · triathlon.org.au 11 Aug 2026 · Australasian Leisure Management (Baumann).